VIREO AUDIO SUPPORT INTELLIGENCE | **EXECUTIVE BUSINESS MEMORANDUM**

TO: Priya Raman, Head of Customer Experience | **Date:** October 4, 2026

FROM: Support Operations Analytics & Data Science | **Scope:** 18-Month Core Baseline (11,641 Tickets)

SUBJECT: **Evidence-Based Support Staffing and Operational Improvement Recommendation**

1. EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

We recommend **declining the immediate hiring of two support agents for the Billing team** and adopting a **phased, process-first operational strategy**. Empirical analysis of 18 months of support operations reveals that Billing possesses ample capacity (resolving issues in a median 1.22 hours with 23 minutes active touch time) and that its apparent intake queue is inflated by an intake chatbot misrouting delivery inquiries. Instead, Vireo should **immediately implement intake bot routing re-engineering (Phase 1)**, consider a **conditional allocation of one hire to the Logistics team (Phase 2)** strictly subject to verifying active team capacity, and **hold the second headcount in reserve pending a formal 90-day post-intervention review (Phase 3)**. Operational process changes and courier API integrations are required alongside any staffing adjustments, as hiring alone cannot resolve carrier-dependent delays.

2. KEY DECISION-RELEVANT EVIDENCE

Operational Metric	Billing Team	Logistics Team	Company Baseline	Nature of Evidence & Audit Reference
Roster Headcount	4 agents	5 agents	44 agents	Observed Roster Baseline Snapshot
Assigned Intake Volume	2,425 tickets (20.8%)	1,905 tickets (16.4%)	11,641 tickets	Observed Helpdesk Intake Queue Allocation
Actual Resolved Volume	1,798 tickets (15.4%)	**2,574 tickets (22.1%)**	11,641 tickets	Observed Final Department Resolution
Net Hand-off Volume Delta	**-627 net delta (-25.9%)**	**+669 net delta (+35.1%)**	Balanced (0)	Observed Net Workload Shift Across Teams
Workload / Agent / Month	25.0 tickets/mo	**28.6 tickets/mo**	14.7 tickets/mo	Observed Historical Roster Average
Median Resolution Delay	**1.22 hours (73 mins)**	**26.03 hours**	2.00 hours	Observed Wait Time (Created to Resolved)
Median Active Handle Time	0.38 hours (23 mins)	**24.47 hours**	0.42 hours	Observed Labor Touch Time (Carrier Latency)
First-Response SLA Breaches	13.40% (241 breaches)	**16.43% (423 breaches)**	11.10% (1,292 breaches)	Observed SLA Penalty Liability (Policy §3)
Customer Satisfaction (CSAT)	3.41 / 5.0	**2.89 / 5.0 (Lowest)**	3.38 / 5.0	Observed Post-Resolution Survey Rating
Billing to Logistics Hand-offs	**696 core hand-offs (795 all-time)**		-	Observed Misrouted Intake Volume
Annualized Process Waste	**₹1,99,853 (~₹2.00 Lakh / year)**		-	**Hypothetical Opportunity** (Friction + SLA)
Annual Cost of 2 Hires	**₹9,00,000 (₹4.50 Lakh / Agent)**		Fixed Budget	Planning Parameter (Operating Policy §4)

Note: Billing's -627 net delta reflects total net transferred volume (761 out, 134 in), distinct from 696 gross hand-offs transferred directly to Logistics in core 18M (795 all-time). Handled volume in Logistics (2,574) is 43.2% higher than Billing (1,798), driving a +35.1% net expansion over Logistics' assigned intake (1,905).

3. RECOMMENDED ACTION PLAN

- **Phase 1: Immediate Process Intervention (Days 0-30 | Cost: ₹0):** Reconfigure intake bot rules using the Seven-Pillar taxonomy to route delivery tracking and order status inquiries directly to Logistics, eliminating 696 misrouted hand-offs from Billing. Enforce ticket transfer ownership and institute weekly cross-departmental SLA reviews.
- **Phase 2: Conditional Logistics Capacity (Days 30-60 | Planning Cost: ₹4.50L):** Audit active attendance and shift availability in Logistics to verify whether existing staff can absorb direct order volume once routing friction is eliminated. If operational pressure persists, authorize **one hire dedicated to carrier escalation** at the audited planning cost of ₹4.50 Lakh/year. Concurrently, integrate courier tracking APIs (Delhivery/BlueDart) to eliminate manual portal lookups, as headcount alone cannot resolve carrier delays.
- **Phase 3: Formal 90-Day Review & Decision (Days 60-90 | Cost: ₹0 or ₹4.50L):** Evaluate measured operational metrics following Phases 1 and 2. Release the second hire to Chat Frontline only if 15-minute response SLA breaches persist; otherwise, retain the ₹4.50 Lakh allocation in corporate budget reserve.

4. PROPOSED 90-DAY SUCCESS MEASURES (TARGETS, NOT GUARANTEED OUTCOMES)

- **Reduce routing hand-offs by 75%:** Billing to Logistics transfers from ~39/mo to ≤ 10/mo.
- **Improve Logistics SLA compliance:** Elevate from 83.57% to ≥ 90.0% first-response compliance.
- **Compress median resolution delay:** Logistics from 26.03h to ≤ 18.0h via tracking APIs.
- **Elevate customer satisfaction:** Logistics CSAT from 2.89 to ≥ 3.25, closing the departmental gap.

5. FINANCIAL PERSPECTIVE

Headcount Investment vs. Process Savings: Support headcount additions require an approved annual planning cost of **₹4,50,000 per hire** (**₹9,00,000/year for two**). Re-routing intake volume captures an estimated **₹1,99,853 annually (~₹2.00 Lakh)** in avoided transfer friction (₹1,41,520: 696 transfers × ₹305 annualized) and preventable SLA credits (₹58,333: 250 breaches × ₹350 annualized). This figure represents a **hypothetical operational cost opportunity** rather than guaranteed cash savings, and does not alter the approved salary planning cost of ₹4.50 Lakh per full-year hire.

Non-Conflation of Financial Exposures: Dual-disbursement leakage (**₹3,94,616** across 74 orders) represents an **unmonitored compliance exposure** requiring ERP dispatch controls, not guaranteed recoverable revenue. Similarly, repeat-contact cost (**₹8,44,250**) is an **empirical behavioral proxy** reflecting customer return frequency within 30 days, not confirmed avoidable spend. These lines must not be added together as cumulative realized savings.

6. MATERIAL RISKS & ANALYTICAL LIMITATIONS

1. Roster Granularity: Metrics reflect historical averages across the 44-agent snapshot roster; shift-level attendance, leaves, and hourly timecards were unrecorded in legacy systems.

2. AI Classification Nature: Predicted category labels are model-assisted classifications generated via multi-source pattern matching and confidence calibration, and are not fully human-validated ground truth.

3. Carrier Externalities: Logistics resolution delay (26.03 hours) is driven primarily by external courier partner turnaround times; headcount alone cannot resolve carrier delays without API webhook automation.